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LEADER IN ADAPTIVE PREPARATION FOR CAT

AIRCAT-2516 Dissection

By the time you appeared for AIRCAT2516, most of you would have become quite familiar with the format/structure of the mock CATs. As always, the ability to understand and adapt to the difficulty level would have provided a big edge to some of you, who applied it better.

For others among you, who have starting taking AIRCATs more recently, it would have been a "baptism by fire" kind of an experience. But then again, as you would have realized on closer scrutiny and analysis post the AIRCAT, you could have done much better even with the same level of preparation. Just getting used to staying calm, picking questions better and using options would have been big positives for you in terms of opportunities that lie ahead.

With nearly 16-20 difficult & intermediate questions in each section, it would have been another "easy-to-score but tough-to-score high" kind of a test for most of you. While on the face of it, DILR would have seemed easier than it was in some of the other AIRCATs, the data is likely to prove otherwise. However, since this time around, most of you were expecting it to be tough, the shock element would have been missing, and you would have felt you had a better shot at doing better than you did earlier.

Let us now look at a detailed sectional analysis in terms of (relative) difficulty level:

	Easy	Intermediate	Difficult	Difficulty Level	Cut off Questions (Marks)
Section I (VRC)	4	8	12	Intermediate to Difficult	10 (19)
Section II (DILR)	2	9	11	Difficult	11 (21)
Section III (QA)	6	10	6	Intermediate	9 (16)
Overall	12	27	29	Difficult	31 (62)

As you can see from the above analysis, it is essentially the difference between the number of easy questions in a section, that is governing the overall level of difficulty, and hence the ease/difficulty of scoring.

SECTION I: Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension (VRC)

The English part was interspersed with intermediate and difficult level questions across various sets. The first passage (HR professionals) was easy to read but had a couple of tricky questions to follow. Cracking the simple structure of the passage (where almost every paragraph laid a point that was elaborated upon) would have got you to score high in this one, and in quick time. The second RC passage (Santiago Nasar) might have appeared easier to tackle because of its relatively shorter length. Neither of the 2 passages that followed were easy if you tried to do all. The 2 questions on summary of short passages would have been time consuming as well. However, the first one was pretty doable. The sentence arrangement questions were must-attempts as not only were they doable, but they were non-negative marking ones as well.

Overall, in this section, even around 14 attempts with not more than 3 wrong would have got you a score of around 30 and that would have taken you to the top 1%ile in the section. A minimum score of around 19-20 was desirable here.

SECTION II: Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning (DILR)
None of the sets in this section were complete sitters and it was the toughest section of the AIRCAT. While the first 2 questions in the first set (where 4 all time legends rate best footballers) were doable even without solving the entire set, the last three needed a comprehensive workout. The mere presence of multiple tables means a high amount of time needed to get a hang of the problem.

The second set was a must attempt for two reasons: One, it was a non-MCQ and hence, had no negative marking; and two, 3 of the 4 questions required you to guess the number of years from a small range possible and hence even intelligent guesswork gave you a shot. So, even though it was a difficult to solve set, but it was worth-attempting.

The 34-38 set, about Benchmark scores of 4 players whose teams played 5 matches, was among the most doable sets in the section, with the first two questions being relatively easier.

The next set about a Celebrity Dance show was also among the more doable sets, with a couple of intermediate questions.

The DI set about Consulting revenues was a must-attempt (given the overall difficulty level of the section) as it had a couple of sitters. However, it also had one tricky question, which expectedly induced over 90% of students to get it wrong.

Overall, even a score of 29 would have got you in the Top 2-%ile and for that you needed to attempt only 2 sets and a little more with a good accuracy.

SECTION III: Quantitative Ability (QA)
The QA part: While there were several questions in the easy/intermediate range, the higher number of individual questions in QA (as opposed to say RC passaged and DILR sets, which have multiple questions once you select a passage/set to solve) would have meant more time in screening, selecting and a general tendency to rush through and make more mistakes. Also, some questions could have been a big drain on your time unless you cracked the logic and used it to derive approximate values rather than accurate ones. One of the most important parts of such a test is the ability to let go of your experience (good or bad) of the previous section and start a new section afresh. Overall, around 11 attempts in this section with not more than 2 wrong, could have got you around 24 marks and ensured a placed in the top 3%ile this section. A minimum score of 18-20 was warranted here.

Summary:
As mentioned earlier, strategy, order of attempting Sets/Questions within a section, time-distribution in terms of planning and actual solving and question selection play a vital role in your chances of success. While question selection and time-distribution within a section are inter-related, strategy would also include decision like which set/passage/type of questions to begin with, in a section.

Overall, even around 30 attempts with ~75% accuracy (24 correct, 6 wrong) would have ensured a score in the vicinity of 64-66 (assuming all MCQs), and ensured a place in the Top 3%ile. It is important to note than the

scores would have fallen off drastically after the top 2-3%ile and a score of around 56 would have meant a near 95%ile mark. This again shows the spread of marks in a relatively tough test, where those who select questions well and apply themselves well, break away from the crowd decisively.

Tentative sectional and overall benchmarks are given below:

	98%ile	95%ile	90%ile	85%ile
Section I (VRC)	26	22	18	16
Section II (DILR)	29	24	20	17
Section III (QA)	25	20	17	14
Overall	67	56	46	42

-AIRCAT Spinner Team (AST)